Country Summary: Australia



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Executive summary of the Australia country profile (2026-11-04). Superscript numbers refer to the numbered sources in Australia_Profile_DRAFT_SOURCES.docx.

At a Glance

27,921,150 Population, 31 March 2026[3]	**71,930** GDP per capita, PPP (international dollars), about, 2025, World Bank[6]	**A$290.7 bn (US$204 bn)** Total health spending, 2024-25, AIHW[46]	**10.5%** Health spending, share of GDP, 2024-25, AIHW[46]
84.1% GP bulk billing rate, April to June 2026[38]	**4.2** Physicians per 1,000 people, 2023, OECD[48]	**81.1 male, 85.1 female** Life expectancy at birth, years, 2022-2024, ABS[14]	**About 17.5%** Population aged 65 and over, 30 June 2025, ABS-based[11]

Country background

Australia is a federal parliamentary constitutional monarchy with its capital in Canberra.[1] Governor-General Sam Mostyn represents the King, and Anthony Albanese is Prime Minister.[1,8] The estimated resident population was 27,921,150 at 31 March 2026, with migration driving most of the 1.4 percent annual growth.[3] The high-income economy is about US$1.80 trillion at market exchange rates (World Bank, 2025) and grew 2.1 percent in the year to June 2026.[7,22] About 17.5 percent of residents were 65 or older at 30 June 2025 on ABS-based figures.[11] The key risk is inflation and rates: consumer prices rose 4.3 percent in the year to September 2026, and the cash rate reached 4.85 percent on 4 November 2026.[24,25]

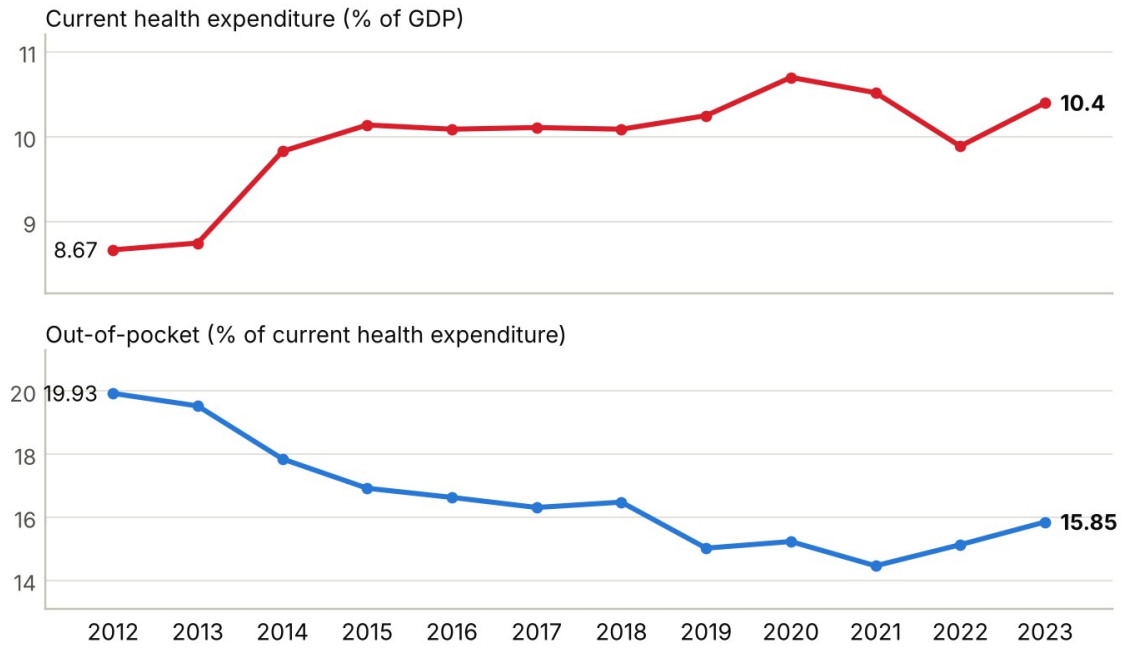
Key takeaways for CSI

- Health spending reached A$290.7 billion in 2024-25, 10.5 percent of GDP, and governments paid 70 percent.[46]
- Dementia was the leading cause of death in 2025 at 10.1 percent, and cancer caused 16.4 percent of disease burden.[26,27]
- Overweight and obesity affected 67 percent of adults in 2022-24, and 61 percent of people had a chronic condition.[28]
- National data show 126,206 employed doctors and 421,796 employed nurses and midwives in 2025.[55,56]

Health System

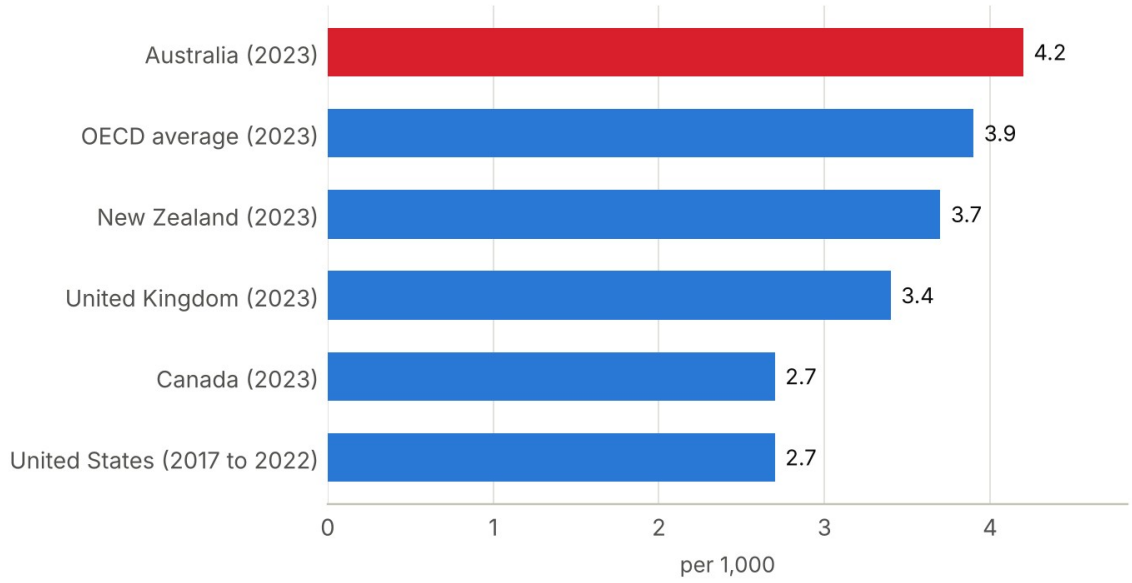
- Medicare covers everyone for core services, and states and territories run public hospitals with Commonwealth funding.[21,32]
- The Commonwealth will give state hospitals a record A$219.6 billion (US$154 billion) from 2026-27 to 2030-31.[8]
- GP bulk billing hit 84.1 percent in April to June 2026, up 4.9 points, toward a 90 percent 2030 target.[38,39]

Australia: health spending and out-of-pocket share, 2012 to 2023



Current health expenditure as a share of GDP, and out-of-pocket spending as a share of current health expenditure (World Bank; 2023 is the latest year). Sources: [47,51]

Practising physicians per 1,000 people, Australia and comparators (2023)

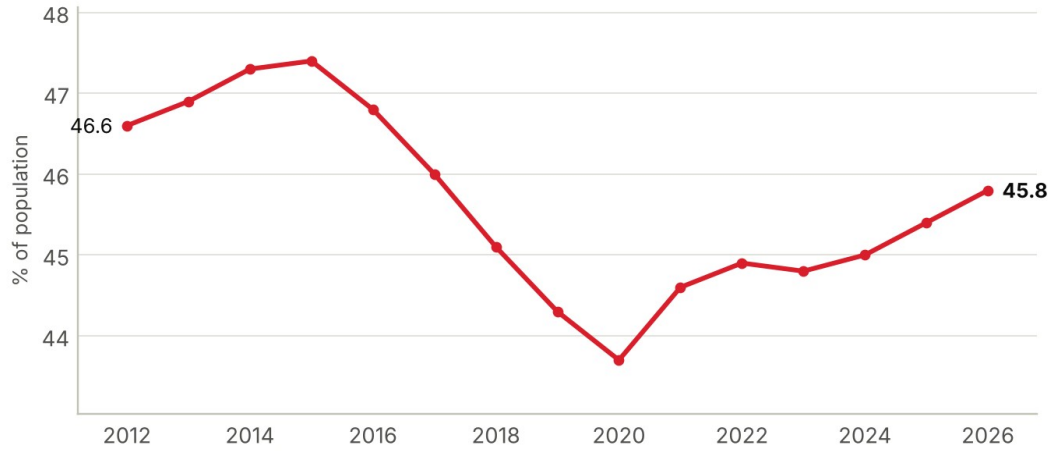


OECD Health at a Glance 2025, Table 1.6. Reference year 2023 unless shown; the United States uses 2017 to 2022 data. The World Bank series counts physicians differently (Australia 4.09 and United States 3.68 for 2022). Sources: [48]

Market and Competition

- At 30 June 2026, 45.8 percent of people had private hospital cover and 55.5 percent had general treatment cover.[40]
- Ramsay Health Care is the largest operator, and private hospitals handled about 40 percent of 2024-25 admissions.[43,44]
- Foreign ties are mainly research and training, such as Cleveland Clinic with Epworth.[64]

Australia: share of population with private hospital cover, June 2012 to June 2026



People with private health insurance hospital treatment cover at 30 June each year, as a share of the population (APRA). Sources: [86]

Foreign health systems active in Australia

18 foreign institutions with confirmed active partnerships (18 in all): 13 research collaboration, 5 training and education. Sources in the profile and the partnerships tracker.



Active foreign health-system partnerships by city of the partner in Australia. Source: CSI partnerships tracker, verified 2026-10-20. Boundaries: Natural Earth; not an official depiction.

Institution	Nature of collaboration
Boston Children's Hospital	Research collaboration
Cleveland Clinic	Training and education
Emory University	Research collaboration
Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center	Research collaboration
Ochsner Health	Training and education
Weill Cornell Medicine	Research collaboration
Apollo Hospitals	Research collaboration
Great Ormond Street Hospital and UCL Great Ormond Street Institute of Child Health	Research collaboration
Ho Chi Minh City Eye Hospital	Training and education
Hokkaido University (Faculty of Health Sciences)	Training and education
Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE)	Research collaboration
Max Healthcare	Research collaboration
Sichuan Provincial People's Hospital	Research collaboration
The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong	Research collaboration
The Christie NHS Foundation Trust	Training and education
The Hospital for Sick Children (SickKids)	Research collaboration
University of Galway (BioInnovate Ireland)	Research collaboration
West China Hospital, Sichuan University	Research collaboration

CSI Position, Risks and Recent News

CSI partnerships in Australia

[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]

To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Opportunities for CSI

[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]

To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Risks and watch items

- A department review found falling private hospital profitability, with several hospitals at high risk of near-term exit.[41]

- The cash rate rose to 4.85 percent, its fifth increase of 2026, pressuring hospital operators and insurance uptake.[25]
- More than 12 percent of surveyed practitioners were unsure about staying or planned to leave.[62]

Recent developments

2026-10-30 Ahpra reported 999,105 registered practitioners, up 4.1 percent, with over 23,000 internationally qualified first-time registrants.[58]

2026-09-14 Receivers will split Healthscope's 25 hospitals among four operators, with Calvary Health Care taking 14.[45]

2026-05-12 Budget 2026-27 gave A$1.8 billion (US$1.26 billion) to make 137 Medicare Urgent Care Clinics permanent.[63]